

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠4

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥6

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♦
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠K

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 4 2

♥ 9 7 4

♦ 10 5 3

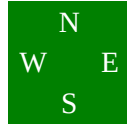
♣ A 9 7

♠ A J 10 5

♥ 8 5

♦ Q 7 2

♣ K Q 5 3



♠ 3

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ 9 8 4

♣ J 10 8 4 2

♠ K Q 8 7

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A K J 6

♣ 6

After SOUTH's 2♣ opening, NORTH bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. NORTH actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

SOUTH's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking NORTH for a 4-card Major. NORTH mentions his ♠s and SOUTH bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now NORTH adds his 12 points to SOUTH's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			
Lead: ♣J			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

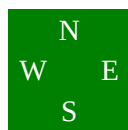
♠ 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ 9 8 7 2
♣ 10 7 6 3

♠ J 5 4

♥ 8 4

♦ A K J 3

♣ J 8 5 2



♠ A K Q 6 3

♥ A K 10 9 6

♦ 10 6

♣ A

♠ 10 9 8 7

♥ 7 3

♦ Q 5 4

♣ K Q 9 4

WEST has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to EAST's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when EAST bids 2♠.

However, when EAST then bids ♥s, WEST finds two more points and bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

2♦ Pass 2♣ Pass

3♣ Pass 2♠ Pass

4♥ 3♥ Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♥3

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 3
♥ 8 3 2
♦ J 6 5 4 3
♣ A 9

♠ Q 10 8 5

♥ A K 6

♦ A K 8

♣ K Q J



♠ A 9 6
♥ J 10 9 4
♦ 9
♣ 10 8 6 4 2

♠ K J 2

♥ Q 7 5

♦ Q 10 7 2

♣ 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠4			

NORTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But SOUTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so NORTH must adapt. She shows her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since NORTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 2
 ♥ A K 5
 ♦ K Q 7 3
 ♣ A 6

♠ 6 5 4

♥ 9 4

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K Q 5 2

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W		E
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♠ K 9 8 7

♥ Q J 8 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ 7 4

♠ 10 3

♥ 10 7 6 3

♦ 5 4

♣ J 10 9 8 3

WEST has a balanced 23-point hand. He opens 2♣.

With 6 points and two 4-card Majors, EAST can only say 2♦.

WEST shows his minimum hand with a 2NT rebid.

Now EAST bids 3♣. This is not the second negative, but rather it is Stayman.

When WEST shows his ♠ suit EAST bids 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by West			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 10
♥ J 8 2
♦ 9 5 4
♣ J 10 9 7

♠ K 7 2

♥ A 9 7 5

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A 5 3



♠ A 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K Q J 8 6

♣ K 4

♠ 9 6 5 4 3

♥ 10 6 3

♦ 3

♣ Q 8 6 2

SOUTH opens 2♣.

NORTH should just respond 2NT, even with 11 points. The idea is to make a positive response (which forces the partnership to game level), and show extra strength later.

This time there is no need. SOUTH should bid 4♣ (Gerber), and NORTH answers 4♠ for two Aces.

Next SOUTH should ask for Kings, and when NORTH shows one King SOUTH should bid 7NT.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			
Lead: ♥6			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ A K 7 2
 ♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 6 5 4
 ♥ J 10 9 8 3
 ♦ 5
 ♣ 9 5 2



♠ 9 7 3
 ♥ 6 2
 ♦ Q J 9 8 6 3
 ♣ A 4

♠ A K Q 10 2
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ 10 4
 ♣ 10 8 7 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
2♣	Pass	3♦	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♦			
All Pass			
6♦ by East			
Lead: ♠K			

When WEST opens 2♣ EAST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But, because her suit is ♦s, she must jump to 3♦.

WEST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that EAST holds one Ace.

That's all EAST needs to know to bid 6♦.